

# Installing EpisodeSleuth on Windows

This guide walks you through setting up everything **EpisodeSleuth** (the phonetic dialogue fingerprinting system) needs on a Windows machine. No programming experience required.

**In a hurry?** Just double-click `install.bat` - it runs the automated setup script which handles everything below. The manual steps are here in case you prefer to do it yourself.

## What you need

| Component                | Why                                                  | Install method                                                                                 |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Python 3.10+</b>      | Runs all the scripts                                 | <code>winget install Py-thon.Python.3.12</code> or <a href="https://python.org">python.org</a> |
| <b>FFmpeg</b>            | Decodes video/audio so the STT engine can process it | <code>winget install Gyan.FFmpeg</code> or <a href="https://ffmpeg.org">ffmpeg.org</a>         |
| <b>Vosk speech model</b> | Offline speech-to-text engine (phonetic matching)    | Downloaded automatically by <code>install.ps1</code>                                           |
| <b>Python packages</b>   | PySide6-Fluent-Widgets, Vosk, metaphone, etc.        | <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code>                                                   |

## Option A: Automatic (recommended)

1. Open the project folder in File Explorer.
2. **Double-click** `install.bat`.
3. Follow any prompts (it may ask to install Python or FFmpeg via `winget`).
4. When it says "Setup complete", you are done. A Desktop shortcut ("EpisodeSleuth") will have been created.

From PowerShell you can also run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1
```

Useful flags:

| Flag        | Effect                                                                         |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -NoVenv     | Install Python packages into the system Python instead of a <code>.venv</code> |
| -NoModel    | Skip the Vosk model download                                                   |
| -NoShortcut | Do not create Desktop / Start-menu shortcuts                                   |
| -Force      | Reinstall packages and re-download the model even if present                   |

## Option B: Manual step-by-step

### 1. Install Python 3

Download from [python.org](https://python.org) (tick “Add Python to PATH” during install), or via winget:

```
winget install Python.Python.3.12
```

Verify:

```
python --version
```

### 2. Install FFmpeg

FFmpeg is needed to decode audio from video files so the speech-to-text engine can process it.

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

Or download manually from [ffmpeg.org](https://ffmpeg.org), extract, and add the `bin\` folder to your system PATH.

Verify:

```
ffmpeg -version
```

### 3. Install Python packages

From the project folder:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs PySide6-Fluent-Widgets (the GUI toolkit), Vosk (speech-to-text), Double Metaphone (phonetic encoding), and other dependencies.

## 4. Download the Vosk speech model

The offline speech-to-text engine needs a language model. Download and extract the small English model:

1. Download: <https://alphacephei.com/vosk/models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15.zip>
2. Extract the zip so you get a folder `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`
3. Move that folder into the project's `models\` directory:

```
models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\
```

( `install.ps1` does this automatically.)

## Running the app

- **GUI:** double-click the **EpisodeSleuth** shortcut (or `fluent_launcher.bat` ), or run `python -m audio_fingerprint.gui`
- **CLI:** `python -m audio_fingerprint.cli.identify --dir "C:\path\to\dvd_rips"`

See [README.md](#) and [USAGE\\_DVD.md](#) for full usage.

## Troubleshooting

| Problem                       | Fix                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>python</code> not found | Make sure "Add Python to PATH" was ticked during install, or open a new terminal                     |
| <code>ffmpeg</code> not found | Open a new terminal (PATH refresh), or add FFmpeg's <code>bin\</code> folder to PATH manually        |
| Vosk model errors             | Check that <code>models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\</code> exists and contains model files          |
| GUI won't start               | Run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again to ensure PySide6-Fluent-Widgets is installed |